



Going up

Twitter is the current blue eyed SM boy, no slump expected



Email or Facebook?

Is email dying due to the advent of social media? We'll find out soon

less at best, terribly over-hyped, and treated like a rug by the masses. And if you think this is mildly sad, the fate of the HD-DVD was even worse with Toshiba backing out after developing and fiercely supporting it. New York-based market research firm Harris Interactive found in a survey conducted in 2009 that although nearly half (47 per cent) of all US consumers owned an HDTV, the numbers for HD-DVD and Blu-ray ready equipment was just 11 per cent and 7 per cent, respectively. Further, when asked if they were likely to buy HD-DVD and Blu-ray equipment in the near future, 91 per cent and 93 per cent people respectively, responded with "not likely at all".

However, let's see if all this 3D hype can revive Blu-ray. It will take time though, and we hope companies are still developing better technology than optical media!

Replaced by: 1 Terabyte hard disk drives; on-demand video content delivered via the Internet; increasing variety of pay-per-view options on Satellite and Cable television; common sense.



Chain email forwards

You know what we're talking about. "Send this email to ((9*10)X8-dy/dx(2x/y^2)) people this very moment, otherwise the giant Yeti will drag you to the North Pole and drown you in liquid Nitrogen". Worse, the email titillated you with all the fulfilment and opulence in the world as a reward for forwarding, because some people thought that it is exactly what you want to read on a Monday morning when you are contemplating killing yourself because of the terrible hangover you have.

Maybe they all died terribly by gangrene of the forwarding finger! One grouse though, why couldn't these people also take the Nigerian spammers with them?

Replaced by: Evolution (survival of the non-forwarder) and progressively increasing median IQ of human beings.

Google Wave

When it comes to the sheer hysteria created before the launch of any technology product since the history of ever, Google Wave cannot be beaten.

Touted as an online real-time collaborative editing tool and backed by a really swanky promotional video, it sure grabbed all the eyeballs and took them home with it. But what is an online real-time collaborative editing tool anyway?

Initially, it was only made available to developers for testing purposes, a little later in 2009, as an extended preview, 100,000 people got a chance to test Wave. At best, it looked like the next generation chat room where you could see the other people typing as they typed, so now you knew just how many typos people really make before hitting 'send'. In an effort to assess how complex Google Wave really was, there were a series of online surveys which pitted Wave against some other difficult to understand aspects of life and users started voting on which among the two they thought was easier to understand. Finally on August 4, 2010, Google announced that they had halted further development on Wave and intended to support the web site for at least the rest of the year.

Replaced by: Nothing, but we don't bear anyone complaining.

Orkut

If someone were to compile a list of jokes that people crack at the expense of Orkut on other social networks today, it would be thicker than The Encyclopedia Britannica. Orkut being at the bottom end of the social media chain right now, finds itself at the worst end of the deal.

Although Orkut was never really applauded for its squeaky clean design, they have somehow progressively managed to make it worse. Currently, it is an impossible feat to log into Orkut without trying to shoot yourself in the face after looking at all those colours and letters flying around in a haphazard way, it's almost as if even the fonts want to run away from the web site. Besides that, Orkut is now the mecca of fake profiles, spam, and hate groups. If someone were to calculate the type of scraps that



people are posting these days, the prize for the highest scrapped phrase would without a doubt go to, "do you wanna friendship with me?" Well, do you?

Replaced by: Facebook

Chat rooms

"asl?" Wouldn't this go down in the annals of history as one of the most remembered technology related phrases of our times? Before social media and Google Talk, chat rooms were where the world went to kill time, and kill time we did. Most guys went there for two main goals: First, to get chatty with someone who had a user-name like SpunkyChick86 and move the conversation over to PM (private messaging.) Failing one, we would find one way or the other to start a flame war to turn a rather mundane day into a full-fledged fight-to-the-bone open for all hate fest. The most effective tactics was cracking off-color jokes or making provocative remarks about sensitive topics such as religion, sexism, politics and sports.

Every once in a while, a moderator would kick a particularly rogue user and ban his/her IP, and that was the end of all fun and games for the next 24 hours or so. Although the chances of any of us having befriended someone through chat and still remain friends with them all through these years are as high as spaghetti raining from the sky, we did have our short-lived virtual chat buddies.

As of 2007, estimates suggest that at least 60 per cent of all users who use Yahoo! chat rooms are bots. They're busy plotting to take over the world on Yahoo! servers. John Connor, where are you?

Replaced by: Social media, 9-to-9 jobs and the rat race. Our generation grew up and found out that we had bills to pay, and miles to go before we could sleep! 